MONTHLY UPDATE

Africa: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-3 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

PROGRESS

INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES · INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION · SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE · COORDINATION AND COLLABORATION · CAPACITY AND INCLUSION · FINANCE

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

Regional collaboration

AFCFTA DIGITAL TRADE CORRIDOR

- **AfCFTA Digital Trade Corridor to Cut Cost of Intra-African Commerce - Wamkele Mene** — MyDailyNewsOnline, 1 September 2026 GHANA

  The AfCFTA Secretary-General set out the case for the Digital Trade Corridor: cutting the cost and complexity of intra-African business by ending the routing of African payments through third countries.

AFRICA PROSPERITY DIALOGUES 2027

- **Africa Prosperity Dialogues 2027 to push for 'borderless Africa' as registration opens September 7** — MyJoyOnline, 2 September 2026

  The Africa Prosperity Network said on 2 September 2026 that its next Africa Prosperity Dialogues will run in Accra from 27 to 29 January 2027, with registration opening on 7 September. Organisers recalled that regional economic communities committed in July 2024 to a continent-wide mobile money interoperability framework by 2027; payments and digital infrastructure are two of the four themes.

- **Africa's integration will fail without harmonised standards and laws - AUDA-NEPAD official** — Asaase Radio, 2 September 2026

  Amine Idriss Adoum, a director at the African Union Development Agency (AUDA-NEPAD), said African institutions have adopted more than 1,000 decisions and declarations on regional integration but implemented fewer than 15%. Speaking at the launch of the Africa Prosperity Dialogues 2027, he blamed unaligned national laws, regulations and technical standards, citing transport rules along the proposed Abidjan–Lagos highway.

CAIRO DECLARATION ON CHILD RIGHTS AND DESIGN ACCOUNTABILITY

- **Osinbajo, African Lawyers Seek Accountability From Tech Firms Over Risks to Children** — Premium Times, 2 September 2026 EGYPT

African lawyers meeting in Cairo reviewed and prioritised six pillars of a proposed declaration on children's rights and design accountability, covering safety-by-design requirements, restrictions on exploitative targeting and manipulative practices, and age-appropriate design standards. The session chair argued companies cannot engineer risk into products and then leave children and parents to manage it.

CENTRAL AFRICAN REGIONAL FRAMEWORK ON CROSS-BORDER DATA FLOWS

- **La CEEAC veut sécuriser sa frontière numérique** — Infos Gabon, 4 September 2026

  ECCAS member states met in Douala from 31 August to 4 September to draft a regional framework governing cross-border data flows in Central Africa, assessing national readiness and consolidating country contributions into a consensus on the pillars of a future instrument. Technical and financial support came from GIZ, AUDA-NEPAD, the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Union Commission.

KOREA-AFRICA ECONOMIC COOPERATION MINISTERIAL FRAMEWORK

- **Korea-Africa Ministerial Conference Convenes Under AI Theme, Two Weeks After Seoul's First AI Loan to the Continent** — iAfrica.com, 5 September 2026 TANZANIA

  The 8th Korea-Africa Economic Cooperation ministerial conference opens in Seoul on 8 September 2026 under an AI and digital infrastructure theme, the first in its twenty-year history. iAfrica links it to Korea's US$170 million concessional loan for a Tanzanian AI institute approved in August. The KOAFEC Trust Fund has provided about US$50 million for project preparation since 2007.

- **2026 KOAFEC Ministerial Conference** — eTrade for all, 8 September 2026

  The African Development Bank co-hosts the 8th Korea-Africa Economic Cooperation ministerial conference in Seoul from 8 to 11 September 2026, with Korea's finance ministry and Export-Import Bank. The theme is harnessing artificial intelligence and digital infrastructure for Africa's transformation, and African finance ministers attend. No financing commitments are stated.

- **Korea Eximbank expands Africa financing in AI, critical minerals** — The Korea Herald, 10 September 2026

  Korea's export-import bank signed a pact with the African Development Bank in Seoul to expand financing for African projects in artificial intelligence, critical minerals and green infrastructure. It was signed during the eighth Korea-Africa economic cooperation ministerial, and the two institutions are to seek expanded joint financing including in digital infrastructure.

- **Le sommet Coree du Sud-Afrique aboutit sur des accords pour la creation d'un hub pour l'IA** — RFI, 12 September 2026

  The Korea-Africa economic cooperation summit, KOAFEC, closed in Seoul on 11 September 2026 with agreements between the African Development Bank and South Korea towards an AI hub for Africa. One is a memorandum on co-financing and preparing government projects; no sums are reported.

- **Africa–Korea: a strengthened partnership to accelerate innovation, investment and the continent's digital transformation** — African Development Bank Group, 15 September 2026

  The African Development Bank and South Korea's finance ministry signed a letter of intent in Seoul on 9 September 2026 to strengthen the Korea-Africa Economic Cooperation (KOAFEC) Trust Fund and cooperate through Korea's Economic Development Cooperation Fund, naming AI and digital technologies as priorities. Korean contributions to the trust fund total US$132.82m; no new sum is attached to the letter.

- **African Development Bank and Korea's National Information Society Agency deepen partnership on Africa's AI and digital transformation** — African Development Bank Group, 16 September 2026

  The African Development Bank and Korea's National Information Society Agency signed a three-year letter of intent in Seoul on 9 September 2026 on data governance, AI-ready datasets and digital public infrastructure. The agency provides expertise and the bank identifies priorities and financing.

- **KOAFEC 2026: African Development Bank, KAIST sign agreement to advance Africa's digital transformation** — African Development Bank Group, 16 September 2026

  The African Development Bank and Korea's KAIST signed a three-year letter of intent in Seoul on 9 September 2026 covering joint research on AI policy and datasets, advice on digital transformation and training for African officials and researchers. No funding figure is attached.

- **KOAFEC 2026: Korea and Africa adopt ambitious roadmap to accelerate continent's digital transformation** — African Development Bank Group, 16 September 2026

  Korea, 45 African countries and the African Development Bank adopted a joint declaration and a 2027-2028 action plan in Seoul on 9 September 2026 centred on AI, digital infrastructure and skills. The plan names thirteen initiatives, among them a regional data embassy in Sierra Leone and compute credits for African AI start-ups; no sums are attached.

AFRICAN UNION ARCHIVES AND REPOSITORY PROJECT

- **African Union Commission Receives South African Delegation for Mission on the AU Archives and Repository Project** — African Union, 7 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  The African Union Commission received a South African delegation in Addis Ababa on 7 September 2026 to restart the project to digitise the African Union's archives and build a common repository system. The delegation, led by an official of South Africa's African Renaissance and International Cooperation Fund, is to stay until 19 September 2026. No cost or timetable for the project is given.

ASSOCIATION OF REGULATORS OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS FOR EASTERN AND SOUTHERN AFRICA (ARICEA)

- **COMESA Calls for Agile Regulation to Keep Pace with Africa's Rapid Digital Transformation** — Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa (COMESA), 9 September 2026

  COMESA assistant secretary-general Mohamed Kadah called for more predictable and agile regulation of digital technologies at the 14th annual general meeting of ARICEA, the Eastern and Southern African ICT regulators' association, in Livingstone, Zambia, on 9 September 2026. He cited data privacy, cybersecurity, AI and cross-border enforcement, and named universal high-speed internet as a priority.

AFRICAN TELECOMMUNICATIONS UNION (ATU)

- **ATU calls for stronger spectrum policy as Africa prepares for WRC-27** — TechReviewAfrica, 10 September 2026 TUNISIA

  The African telecommunications union's secretary-general called for stronger alignment among African administrations on spectrum policy, at the 11th Africa spectrum management conference in Tunis. He singled out the mid-band ranges where mobile broadband demand will need capacity and coordination, and argued that policy must extend beyond identifying frequencies to how spectrum is priced and licensed.

AFRICAN COMMON POSITION FOR THE ITU PLENIPOTENTIARY CONFERENCE 2026

- **AIP/ La Côte d'Ivoire appelle à une position africaine unie sur les enjeux du numérique à l'approche de la PP-26** — AIP - Agence Ivoirienne de Presse, 15 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Côte d'Ivoire's digital transition minister Djibril Ouattara opened the last African preparatory meeting for the ITU Plenipotentiary Conference in Abidjan on 15 September 2026, calling for a common African position before the Doha conference in November. He announced Côte d'Ivoire's candidacy for the ITU Council for 2027-2030. The African Telecommunications Union said about 18 African countries are contesting 13 Council seats.

- **Télécommunications : La 4e et dernière réunion préparatoire africaine avant la PP-26 de Doha s'est ouverte à Abidjan** — Afrik Soir, 15 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Côte d'Ivoire opened the fourth and final African preparatory meeting for the ITU Plenipotentiary Conference in Abidjan on 15 September 2026, under the African Telecommunications Union. The meeting, closing on 17 September, is to settle common African proposals and candidatures for the Doha conference. The union also launched the fifth edition of its Innovation Challenge, with US$60,000 in prizes.

- **Africa concludes final preparatory meeting ahead of ITU Plenipotentiary Conference 2026** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  African states closed their fourth and final preparatory meeting for the 2026 ITU Plenipotentiary Conference in Abidjan on 17 September 2026 with 46 African Common Proposals for the conference in Doha. The proposals cover connectivity, digital transformation, skills and inclusive digital services; space and spectrum regulation were among the most debated issues.

- **ITU Africa Regional Director Emmanuel Manasseh highlights coordinated African priorities ahead of PP-26** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  The International Telecommunication Union's Africa director, Emmanuel Manasseh, said African states refined common proposals for the 2026 Plenipotentiary Conference at their fourth and final preparatory meeting in Abidjan, reported on 18 September 2026. The next step is an inter-regional preparatory meeting in Saudi Arabia on 13 and 14 October 2026.

- **Space regulation emerges as key issue ahead of ITU Plenipotentiary Conference 2026** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  African telecommunications bodies concluded their last preparatory meeting for the 2026 ITU Plenipotentiary Conference in Abidjan, where space regulation was widely debated, reported on 18 September 2026. Eric Fournier, France's candidate to head the ITU Radiocommunication Bureau, presented his candidacy and met Côte d'Ivoire's digital minister and telecoms regulator.

COMESA REGIONAL AI STRATEGY AND MODEL FRAMEWORK

- **PRESS STATEMENT: COMESA Advances Responsible AI Dialogue** — Digitalization in Eastern and Southern Africa (IDEA) / COMESA, 16 September 2026 ESWATINI

  COMESA held a regional meeting in Mbabane, Eswatini, from 16 to 18 September 2026 to validate a draft study of artificial intelligence and emerging technologies across its member states. The World Bank-funded study is the first phase of work towards a Regional AI Strategy, model policy guidelines and a model regulatory framework. No timetable for those instruments is given.

AFRICA INTERNET GOVERNANCE FORUM

- **UNECA Continental Call for African AI Innovations** — Africa Internet Governance Forum, 18 September 2026

The UN Economic Commission for Africa, with the ITU and Research ICT Africa, invited African innovators to apply to present AI-based solutions at an Innovation Café during the 15th Africa Internet Governance Forum in Accra, 2–5 November 2026. Startups, universities, public bodies and individuals may apply; selected entries join a policy exchange and an exhibition.

AFRICAN FINANCIAL STABILITY REPORT

- **CBE governor heads Egypt delegation at 48th annual AACB meetings** — Daily News Egypt, 20 September 2026 EGYPT

  The Association of African Central Banks approved a second edition of the African Financial Stability Report and constituted the board of the African Monetary Institute, closing its 48th annual meetings in Nairobi with the governors of 34 of its 41 member central banks present. Egypt joined the Bureau of Governors as deputy chair for North Africa and chairs the taskforce preparing the report, which is to be published through the stability committee's portal.

AFRICAN MONETARY INSTITUTE

- **CBE governor heads Egypt delegation at 48th annual AACB meetings** — Daily News Egypt, 20 September 2026 EGYPT

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

AFRICAN CONTINENTAL HEALTH DATA GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

- **Health leaders to explore intelligent health systems at Kigali summit** — IGIHE, 27 September 2026 RWANDA

  The Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention and Smart Africa are co-hosting the fifth Africa HealthTech Summit in Kigali from 30 September to 2 October 2026, IGIHE reported on 27 September. Africa CDC and Transform Health will hold a consultation on the draft African Continental Health Data Governance Framework on 30 September.

- **Africa CDC calls for stronger health data governance across Africa** — Tech Review Africa, 1 October 2026

  Africa CDC called on member states to strengthen national health data stewardship and adopt interoperable digital standards, at a consultative session at the Africa HealthTech Summit in Kigali.

- **Africa CDC official: Continent lacks infrastructure to run its own health AI** — The New Times, 3 October 2026 RWANDA

  The head of digital health at the Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention said most health AI models presented to her are hosted on a foreign cloud, because the continent lacks the infrastructure to run them. The agency is drafting a continental health data governance framework with more than 40 member states, setting who may access health data, for what purpose and for how long.

MODEL LAW ON ACCESS TO INFORMATION FOR AFRICA (2013)

- **International Day for Universal Access to Information - 28 September 2026** — African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights, 28 September 2026

  The African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights will review its 2013 Model Law on Access to Information next year to add digital-age provisions. It also points to its guidelines for states on monitoring technology companies and for platforms serving the public interest, and to draft guidelines on access to data.

AFRINIC GOVERNANCE AND RECEIVERSHIP

- **AFRINIC Elections 2026 - Select the next PDP Co-Chair** — AFRINIC, 1 October 2026

  AFRINIC opened candidate registration for one of its two policy development co-chair seats, closing on 29 October. The seat will be filled at the public policy meeting on 18 November.

CAIRO DOCUMENT FOR TRUST AND AFRICAN DIGITAL INTEGRATION

- **African diplomats in Cairo agree to develop African digital integration roadmap** — Ahram Online, 4 October 2026 EGYPT

  Representatives of 11 African diplomatic missions in Cairo agreed to draft a joint Cairo Document for Trust and African Digital Integration. It is to set shared priorities on digital investment, digital trade, cybersecurity, data governance and emerging technologies.

GUIDELINES ON PUBLIC INTEREST CONTENT IN THE DIGITAL ERA

- **CALL FOR CONTRIBUTIONS: Draft Guidelines on Public Interest Content in the Digital Era** — African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights, 8 October 2026

  The African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights invited comments by 8 January 2027 on draft Guidelines on Public Interest Content in the Digital Era, in a call dated 8 October 2026. The draft, prepared by its special rapporteur on freedom of expression under a 2025 resolution, sets out state obligations and responsibilities for technology companies and digital infrastructure services.

PRIMARY HEALTH CARE CONTINENTAL COORDINATION MECHANISM (DIGITAL HEALTH FORUM)

- **Primary Health Care Continental Coordination Mechanism (PHC-CCM) Outcome Statement** — Africa CDC, 8 October 2026

  African Union member states meeting in Addis Ababa on 4-5 June 2026 endorsed a Primary Health Care Continental Coordination Mechanism convened by Africa CDC, including a digital health forum on interoperability and data governance. They committed to apply the Africa Digital Health Maturity Assessment Tool and build costed digital health investment cases. Africa CDC posted the statement on 8 October 2026.

Instruments and harmonisation

Data protection · Standards · AI

Data protection

NETWORK OF AFRICAN DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITIES (NADPA-RAPDP)

- **Signed-Sealed-Delivered: 21 September Africa Data Protection Day** — Tsitsi Mariwo (LinkedIn), 4 September 2026

  The board of the Network of African Data Protection Authorities, made up of the authorities of Cabo Verde, Côte d'Ivoire and Zimbabwe, signed a declaration on 3 September 2026 proclaiming 21 September as Africa Data Protection Day. It carries out a decision taken at the network's annual meeting in May 2026.

Standards

AFRICA PKI FORUM HARMONISATION OF DIGITAL-TRUST RULES

- **Africa cannot outsource its digital sovereignty - NIMC** — Newsverge Nigeria News, 2 September 2026 NIGERIA

The head of Nigeria's National Identity Management Commission, Abisoye Odusote, told GITEX Nigeria in Lagos on 2 September 2026 that Africa must train its own cryptographers and digital trust specialists, and called for aligned certificate policies, data privacy and legal frameworks. At the same event the AfCFTA secretary-general, Wamkele Mene, urged faster implementation of the Protocol on Digital Trade.

- **GITEX Nigeria 2026: NIMC Boss Urges African Digital Framework** — Techeconomy, 3 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria's identity commission head Abisoye Coker-Odusote called for a common African digital trust framework for identity checks, e-signatures and cross-border transactions at GITEX Nigeria 2026 in Lagos. She said the National Identity Management Act 2026 makes NIMC the root certificate authority for the national public key infrastructure, and urged states to build systems that recognise each other's credentials.

- **Lagos, NIMC, AfCFTA demand local data sovereignty at GITEX 2026** — The Guardian Nigeria, 3 September 2026 NIGERIA

  At the opening of GITEX Nigeria 2026 in Lagos, the heads of Nigeria's identity commission (NIMC) and the AfCFTA Secretariat, with Lagos State officials, called for Africa to build and own its digital public infrastructure. NIMC's Abisoye Coker-Odusote said the National Identity Management Act 2026 makes NIMC root certificate authority for the national public key infrastructure.

AFRICAN COMMON PROPOSALS FOR WRC-27

- **3rd African Preparatory Meeting for WRC-27 (APM27-3) and the 11th African Spectrum Management Conference** — African Telecommunications Union (ATU), 7 September 2026 TUNISIA

  The African Telecommunications Union published the draft agenda and working-group schedule for the third African Preparatory Meeting for the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference, held in Tunis on 7–11 September 2026 alongside the 11th African Spectrum Management Conference. The agenda covers the ITU's preparatory work plan, other regions' positions and the WRC-27 agenda items.

- **African Delegations Seek Common Ground in Tunis Ahead of 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference** — African Telecommunications Union (ATU), 9 September 2026 TUNISIA

  African governments and telecoms regulators opened four days of talks in Tunis on 8 September 2026 to build common spectrum positions ahead of the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference. Hosted by Tunisia's National Frequency Agency and coordinated by the African Telecommunications Union, it is the third such preparatory meeting, after Maseru in 2024 and Nairobi in 2025.

- **ATU calls for stronger spectrum policy as Africa prepares for WRC-27** — TechReviewAfrica, 10 September 2026 TUNISIA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **African Delegations Demand Common Ground In Tunis Ahead Of 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference** — Cyber Era, 17 September 2026 TUNISIA

  African governments and regulators opened four days of talks in Tunis to build common positions on the radio frequencies used by mobile, satellite and other wireless services, ahead of the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference. Broadband capacity, rural connectivity and future communications technologies are the focus.

- **South Sudan Advances Satellite Connectivity Agenda at African Telecom Meeting** — TechAfrica News, 17 September 2026 SOUTH SUDAN

  South Sudan's National Communication Authority took part in the third African preparatory meeting for the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference, held in Tunisia. Non-geostationary satellite systems and direct-to-device connectivity were among the items African regulators worked on for common regional positions.

AFRINIC IPV6 POLICY PROPOSAL AFPUB-2026-V6-001 (IPV6 AS A CRITERION IN IPV4 SOFT LANDING)

- **AFRINIC's IPv6-for-IPv4 Rule Needs a Control Test** — BTW Media, 7 September 2026

  A draft AFRINIC policy would tie any new IPv4 request to IPv6 eligibility, a deployment plan and percentage targets over 12, 24 and 48 months. The registry's own impact assessment says the evidence standard and the top-25 measurement method are not defined and warns smaller operators may face a disproportionate burden; AFRINIC 37 reached no consensus and the proposal returned to the mailing list.

- **IPv6 as a criteria in IPv4 Soft Landing (AFPUB-2026-v6-001-DRAFT02)** — AFRINIC, 14 June 2026

  A draft policy before AFRINIC, the African internet registry, would require anyone requesting IPv4 addresses to also request IPv6 space and file a deployment plan, with IPv6 reachability targets of 25%, 50% and 75% over 12, 24 and 48 months. The proposal cites African IPv6 capability of 6% against 44% worldwide. It did not reach consensus at AFRINIC 37 on 24 June 2026 and remains under discussion.

AFRINIC POLICY PROPOSAL AFPUB-2026-GEN-001-DRAFT02 (PDP WORKING GROUP GUIDELINES AND PROCEDURES)

- **PDP Working Group (WG) Guidelines and Procedures (AFPUB-2026-GEN-001-DRAFT02)** — AFRINIC, 7 September 2026

  A second draft of a proposal to rewrite the rules of AFRINIC's policy development working group was submitted on 7 September 2026 and is under discussion. The authors say the registry's recent lack of a board quorum left adopted policies unratified and committees unrenewed; the draft would need changes to AFRINIC's bylaws.

- **AFRINIC's proposed policy petition is a Board-absence mechanism** — BTW Media, 11 October 2026

  An analysis of the second draft of AFRINIC's policy-process guidelines finds that its petition route, which lets the working group seek ratification of a policy, opens only when no operative Board exists. It needs 15 supporters from three subregions and still depends on a change to the Bylaws.

AFRINIC POLICY PROPOSAL AFPUB-2026-GEN-003-DRAFT01 (PUBLIC POLICY MEETING DATES)

- **[rpd] New draft policy proposal PPM Dates AFPUB-2026-GEN-003-DRAFT01** — AFRINIC Resource Policy Discussion (RPD) mailing list, 17 September 2026

  AFRINIC's Policy Development Working Group received a draft policy proposal on public policy meeting dates, AFPUB-2026-GEN-003-DRAFT01, from author Jordi Palet on 14 September 2026 and opened it for comment. On the mailing list, one participant argued meeting scheduling is an operational matter for the board, while the author replied that the community may use the policy process to address it.

- **[rpd] RPD Digest, Vol 224, Issue 17** — AFRINIC Resource Policy Discussion (RPD) mailing list, 18 September 2026

  Participants on AFRINIC's Resource Policy Discussion mailing list debated whether the dates of its public policy meetings should be set through the policy development process or left to the board and staff as an operational matter. One contributor, writing on 18 September 2026, asked the proposal's authors to state the problem it solves and what authority the process has to prescribe dates. No decision is recorded.

ITU DIGITAL FINANCIAL SERVICES SECURITY RECOMMENDATIONS

- **How an ITU security lab advances trust in digital financial services** — International Telecommunication Union (ITU), 23 September 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The International Telecommunication Union says its Digital Financial Services Security Lab has assisted more than 20 countries in Africa, the Caribbean and Latin America to test mobile payment apps for security. Its guidelines for regulators have been adopted by the southern and east African regulators' associations, CRASA and EACO; the central African body is considering them and the West African one has a draft.

AFRINIC IPV4 POLICY PROPOSAL AFPUB-2026-IPV4-001 (SOFT LANDING, RECOVERED SPACE AND PRIORITY)

- **AFRINIC ratifies three policies with different implementation clocks** — btw.media, 7 October 2026

  AFRINIC's board ratified three internet number-resource policies on 25 September 2026, all listed as awaiting implementation, btw.media reported on 7 October. They cover a quarantine for recovered IPv4 space (about six months to implement), documented exceptions to the 90% utilisation threshold (within 30 days), and hierarchical names for new AS-SETs, which waits on the MyAFRINIC v2 system.

AFRINIC IPV4 POLICY PROPOSAL AFPUB-2026-IPV4-002 (WAIVER OF THE 90% UTILISATION THRESHOLD)

- **AFRINIC ratifies three policies with different implementation clocks** — btw.media, 7 October 2026

  Summarised under Standards.

AI

PAN-AFRICAN AI GOVERNANCE RESEARCH AND ADVOCACY PROJECT

- **Africa cannot afford to scale AI faster than it can govern it** — BusinessDay NG, 2 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Roseline Ilori of Bridge57 Solutions argues that Africa cannot scale AI faster than it can govern it, and that the question worth asking is not how quickly the continent adopts the technology but whether the systems being deployed are safe, fair, transparent and accountable. The gap she names is institutional rather than technical: regulators unable to supervise automated systems, businesses that do not understand the risks, and citizens with no way to challenge an algorithmic decision.

TRAINING DATA FOR AFRICAN LANGUAGES

- **This AI research company wants to put 1,000 African languages into AI** — TechCabal, 8 September 2026

  A research lab founded in 2020 is building training data covering a thousand African languages, after finding what exists both scarce and poor.

USE OF AI TOOLS BY JUDICIAL OPERATORS, AND TRAINING FOR IT

- **African Court, UNESCO strengthen judicial capacity on responsible use of Artificial Intelligence – AI** — African Court on Human and Peoples' Rights, 15 September 2026

  The African Court on Human and Peoples' Rights and UNESCO opened a four-day seminar on AI and the rule of law in Arusha on 15 September 2026 for more than 50 judges and staff, based on UNESCO's justice-sector toolkit. UNESCO cited its survey finding that 44% of judicial operators worldwide use AI tools but only 9% have had formal guidance or training.

AU GUIDELINES ON AI GOVERNANCE AND REGULATION

- **WEBINAR 23-24 SEP 12:00 UTC – African Union Open Stakeholder Consultation on AI Governance and Regulation** — Internet Society News, 23 September 2026

The African Union Commission is holding an open online consultation on 23 and 24 September on its draft Guidelines on AI Governance and Regulation, which implement the 2024 Continental AI Strategy. Day two covers regulation, security and standards, including the AU Model AI Law; written submissions are accepted until 30 September.

- **The AU's Question: What 55 Countries Need to Agree on Before Africa Can Govern AI** — Tech Africa News, 29 September 2026

  The African Union Commission's AI coordinator said 17 countries have now formally adopted national AI policies, against eight when the continental strategy was written, at the consultation on continental AI governance guidelines. Draft guidelines and a model AI law are being prepared for ministerial review.

HUB FOR AI AND DISABILITY INCLUSION (HAIDI) AND AFRICAN DISABILITY DATA NETWORK (ADDN)

- **How Africa's AI boom is leaving 100 million disabled citizens behind** — TechCabal, 24 September 2026
  GHANA KENYA

  A Hub for AI and Disability Inclusion (HAIDI), hosted by KNUST's Responsible AI Lab, and an African Disability Data Network were launched at the Global Data Festival in Nairobi with backing from IDRC, the UK FCDO and AI4D. They plan to map disability-related datasets, build three new datasets, assess how national AI strategies treat disability and fund three startups with grants of up to KES 5 million.

GLOBAL INDEX ON RESPONSIBLE AI, AFRICAN RESULTS

- **African AI governance dialogue calls for practical, context-responsive frameworks** — Tech Review Africa, 30 September 2026

  A pre-FIFAfrica dialogue convened by the Global Center on AI Governance, Digital Action and CIPESA called for African AI governance principles to be turned into concrete commitments on training data, worker participation and community interests.

ATLAS UMOJA AI POLICY WORKSTREAM (AUDA-NEPAD)

- **AUDA-NEPAD launches ATLAS Umoja AI Policy workstream** — Tech Review Africa, 1 October 2026

  The African Union's development agency launched and chairs an AI policy workstream, ATLAS Umoja, on AI governance and African-language AI. A mobile industry official said at the launch that fewer than 2% of African languages are meaningfully supported by today's AI models.

WORLD BANK AFRICA ECONOMIC UPDATE, OCTOBER 2026: BUILDING AI READINESS

- **Africa Economic Update, October 2026: Building AI Readiness** — World Bank, 1 October 2026
  SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The World Bank's Africa Economic Update for October 2026 focuses on readiness for artificial intelligence. It puts Sub-Saharan Africa's share of global data-centre capacity at 0.6%, counts 39 countries with data-protection laws, and scores the region at 41.6 on AI governance against 52.6 globally. It forecasts 2026 growth of 4.3%.

- **World Bank raises Africa's 2026 growth forecast, urges AI investments** — Reuters via CNBC Africa, 6 October 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The World Bank's October Africa Economic Update urges Sub-Saharan governments to invest in AI for productivity and jobs, pointing to low-cost applications on affordable devices, shared data centres and stronger data-protection laws. It puts the region's 2026 growth at 4.3%, 0.3 of a point above its April forecast.

COMMISSION STUDY ON HUMAN AND PEOPLES' RIGHTS AND ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (RESOLUTION 473)

- **Paradigm Initiative's Statement to the African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights on the Human Rights Situation in Africa at the 89th Ordinary Session** — Paradigm Initiative, 13 October 2026 GABON ZAMBIA

  Paradigm Initiative, a digital rights organisation, told the African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights' 89th session that AI is spreading in Africa without adequate law. It cited the use of Zambia's 2025 Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act against media during the August 2026 elections, and criticised blanket online bans on children such as Gabon's April 2026 under-16 ordinance.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity · Data Storage · Energy · Cybersecurity · Data Exchange · Digital Payments and Fintech · Sectoral management information systems

Connectivity

IPV6 CAPABILITY ACROSS THE AFRINIC SERVICE REGION

- **IPv6 as a criteria in IPv4 Soft Landing (AFPUB-2026-v6-001-DRAFT02)** — AFRINIC, 14 June 2026

  Summarised under Standards.

5G FIXED WIRELESS ACCESS OPERATORS

- **The New Last Mile: Why African Broadband is Moving Outdoors** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026 KENYA NIGERIA SOUTH AFRICA

  Tech Africa News reports that by May 2026, 40 operators in 37 African markets had launched commercial 5G fixed wireless access, using outdoor receivers mounted on homes instead of laying fibre. Safaricom reported 132,060 5G fixed wireless subscribers in the first half of its 2025/26 financial year, up 53%, and Airtel sells such services in Nigeria and Kenya.

AIRTEL AFRICA NETWORK EXPANSION PROGRAMME

- **Airtel Africa to Invest $1.1bn for Network Expansion across Africa** — ThisDay, 10 September 2026 NIGERIA

  A pan-African operator has earmarked US$1.1 billion for expanding and upgrading its network across its African operations, its chief executive said in a broadcast interview. He said spending has already risen from about US$120 million to US$390 million across 14 markets, with Nigeria its biggest.

MOBILE INTERNET USERS AND THEIR MEASURED ECONOMIC VALUE

- **GSMA Warns of Growing AI Divide as Smartphone Costs Rise in Emerging Markets** — Tech Africa News, 15 September 2026 GLOBAL

  An industry association's 2026 connectivity report warns of a divide between artificial intelligence haves and have-nots: more than 3.4 billion people do not use mobile internet although over 90 per cent of them live inside mobile broadband coverage, with smartphone affordability the obstacle.

- **Advancing digital connectivity in Africa: Charting Africa's path to 1 billion connected people by 2030** — GSMA Intelligence for the Partnership for Digital Access in Africa (PDAA), 21 September 2026

  The report behind the GSMA and PDAA roadmap, summarised under the launch. It counts 550 million internet users in Africa in 2025 (36% of the population) and projects about 700 million by 2030 on current trends. Halving the coverage and usage gaps could add some 514 million people and take the total past 1 billion.

- **GSMA and PDAA Unveil Roadmap to Close Africa's Mobile Internet Usage Gap and Connect One Billion People by 2030** — GSMA, 21 September 2026

  The GSMA and the Partnership for Digital Access in Africa launched a roadmap in New York on 21 September 2026 on how to reach 1 billion connected Africans by 2030. Based on 11 markets, it finds about 906 million people living within mobile broadband coverage but not using the mobile internet, against 122 million with no coverage at all. Its three priorities are moving over 600 million 2G and 3G connections to 4G or 5G, investing in energy and connectivity together, and reaching rural areas more cheaply.

ADVANCING DIGITAL CONNECTIVITY IN AFRICA ROADMAP (GSMA AND PDAA)

- **Advancing digital connectivity in Africa: Charting Africa's path to 1 billion connected people by 2030** — GSMA Intelligence for the Partnership for Digital Access in Africa (PDAA), 21 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **GSMA and PDAA Unveil Roadmap to Close Africa's Mobile Internet Usage Gap and Connect One Billion People by 2030** — GSMA, 21 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

ATU-TESPOK INTERNET EXCHANGE POINT ROADMAP

- **New Roadmap by Africa's Telecom Union and Kenya's Tech Industry Association Targets Cheaper, More Reliable Internet** — African Telecommunications Union (LinkedIn article), 11 October 2026

  The African Telecommunications Union and the Technology Service Providers Association of Kenya (TESPOK) published a joint roadmap to strengthen internet exchange points in Africa. It builds on their assessment counting about 57 operational exchanges in 36 countries as of mid-2025, and proposes a continental coordination body, a model national framework and an IXP development fund. No funding amount is given.

Data Storage

AFRICAN SHARE OF GLOBAL DATA-CENTRE CAPACITY

- **Interview: Liquid bets on AI as next growth frontier for Africa's fibre network** — TechTrends KE, 10 September 2026 KENYA

  The same operator is repositioning from connectivity provider to a layered artificial intelligence, cloud and cybersecurity business on top of its fibre backbone, its vice-president and chief executive said at a Nairobi conference. Connectivity becomes the foundation of digital infrastructure rather than the product, he argued, naming data-centre capacity as the concern African telecom executives raise most.

- **Africa's Green Data Centre Opportunity: Solar-Powered Server Farms** — TechTrends Africa, 17 September 2026

  African data centres face grids that fail outright rather than merely cost too much, and operators are increasingly building solar-powered server farms from the start instead of retrofitting diesel-dependent ones. The continent holds under 1 per cent of global data-centre capacity, with an industry association putting the shortfall at 1,000MW across some 700 further facilities.

- **Data centers : WIOCC prépare un bond de capacités en Afrique avec l'appui américain** — La Tribune (Agence Ecofin), 18 September 2026

The US International Development Finance Corporation approved an equity investment of up to about US$155m in WIOCC, part of which is to add about 25MW of data centre capacity in Africa. The DFC puts the whole programme at up to US$450m, including submarine and terrestrial networks. Days earlier WIOCC signed a US$300m subscription with Africa Finance Corporation and Vision Invest.

AMAZON WEB SERVICES INVESTMENT IN AFRICAN CLOUD INFRASTRUCTURE

- **AWS puts $2.3bn behind Africa's cloud, AI future** — ITWeb South Africa, 10 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  A large cloud provider says it has invested more than US$819 million in African infrastructure since 2018 and committed a further US$1.5 billion to 2029, with 154 services now available in its Cape Town region. Its general manager for Sub-Saharan Africa told a Johannesburg summit the Africa strategy is increasingly aimed at local developers building for regional markets, and claimed more than a million Africans trained in cloud and AI skills.

CONTINENTAL DATA-CENTRE CAPACITY AGAINST PROJECTED DEMAND

- **Africa's Billion Dollar AI Data Centre Rush Is Real. Its Power and Water Aren't.** — iAfrikan, 11 September 2026 EGYPT SOUTH AFRICA

  An iAfrikan analysis sets two September 2026 announcements — Egypt's $1bn sovereign AI data-centre programme with about $200m committed to its first phase, and MTN's 150MW venture across Nigeria and South Africa — against power and water limits. It cites Africa Data Centres Association figures of 360MW active, 238MW under construction and 656MW planned, and McKinsey's estimate of 1.5–2.2GW of demand by 2030.

UNDP AI INFRASTRUCTURE ACTIVATION PROGRAMME

- **Local AI compute infrastructure in Africa: Lessons from six country-hosted deployments on governance and effective use** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Regional Bureau for Africa, 17 September 2026 KENYA MALAWI RWANDA SOUTH AFRICA TOGO ZAMBIA

  The UN Development Programme's Africa bureau published lessons on 17 September 2026 from the AI computing capacity it deployed in Kenya, Malawi, Rwanda, South Africa, Togo and Zambia. It identified 21 AI applications across the six, and found that data readiness, skills, institutional ownership and financing, not hardware, determine how far the compute is used.

DATA CENTRES THE AFCFTA SECRETARIAT STATES DIGITAL TRADE REQUIRES

- **'Africa needs data centre surge' to keep up with the digital economy** — Sunday Times / Business Times, 19 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  The head of the continental free trade area told a conference that Africa should aim for more than 700 data centres within ten years to carry a digital economy he put at 700 billion dollars. About 260 are counted now, and he named South Africa, Nigeria and Kenya as the builds to replicate.

Energy

EMERGENT GRID PROJECT (COMPUTING LOAD AS A MINI-GRID ANCHOR CUSTOMER)

- **The Rockefeller Foundation and Mission 300 Accelerator Launch Demonstration to Test Whether AI Demand Can Help Finance Energy Access in Africa** — The Rockefeller Foundation, 24 September 2026 KENYA DRC SIERRA LEONE

The Rockefeller Foundation's Mission 300 Accelerator announced the Emergent Grid Project on 24 September 2026, testing whether AI computing placed at African mini-grids can act as an anchor customer and improve their finances. The first sites are five in Kenya, a solar plant in DR Congo and three in Sierra Leone, serving about 85,000 people, with local electricity demand given priority over computing. No amount is stated.

Cybersecurity

REPORTED CYBERCRIME LOSSES ACROSS THE CONTINENT

- **AI now enables 55% of cybercrime in Africa as losses hit $484m – CID** — GBC Ghana Online (Ghana Broadcasting Corporation), 2 September 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's police CID put Interpol's 2026 African Cyber Threat Assessment on the record at the awareness month launch: AI now enables 55% of reported cybercrime in Africa, with related losses of $484 million. CID director-general COP Lydia Yaako Donkor described generative AI supplying convincing phishing messages, cloned voices and synthetic images and video, with cryptocurrency, mule accounts and fraudulent investment schemes moving the proceeds — an industrialised, borderless ecosystem rather than isolated offending. She tied Ghana's exposure directly to the spread of mobile money, internet banking and instant transfers.

AFRICAN NETWORK OF CYBERSECURITY AUTHORITIES

- **'Morocco CyberSecurity Week' Kicks off in Rabat** — Maroc.ma (MAP), 12 October 2026 MOROCCO

  Morocco's information systems security directorate is hosting a three-day cybersecurity event in Rabat from 12 to 14 October, with an ITU exercise drawing representatives of about thirty countries. The African Network of Cybersecurity Authorities meets on its sidelines.

Data Exchange

AFRICA ACCELERATOR FOR DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE (AA4DPI)

- **CDPI on its session at the Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, 2–3 September 2026** — Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure (CDPI), 3 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE ZAMBIA

  The Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure led a session at the Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, hosted by UNDP and the Centre for Open Societal Systems on 2 and 3 September 2026. Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia covered DPI blueprints, verifiable credentials, consented data sharing and reusable open-source code.

- **Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure (AA4DPI)** — United Nations Development Programme, 8 September 2026

  UNDP has published the standing description of its Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, led jointly by the Regional Bureau for Africa and the Digital and AI Hub, which supports countries to assess digital readiness, strengthen governance, build implementation capacity and develop investment-ready programmes across digital identity, digital payments and data exchange. Its first published cohort session ran on 2 and 3 September with delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia; no budget, duration or deliverable set is published for the accelerator itself.

- **UNDP's AA4DPI Programme Deepens South-South Cooperation on Digital Public Infrastructure** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), 8 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE ZAMBIA

> Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia, with African Union representatives, concluded a two-week South-South learning mission to India on digital public infrastructure. Convened under UNDP's newly launched Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, it took delegates through New Delhi, Pune and Bengaluru to examine India's digital identity, payment and data exchange systems.

Digital Payments and Fintech

AFRICAN TAKE-UP OF CHINA'S CROSS-BORDER INTERBANK PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **Grey targets Africa-China trade with direct yuan payments** — TechCabal, 1 September 2026

  The cross-border payments startup Grey launched direct yuan payouts into Chinese bank accounts from dollar, euro, sterling and stablecoin balances, aimed at African importers trading with China.

- **Ecobank to join China's CIPS payments platform for yuan settlement** — CNBC Africa (Reuters), 9 October 2026

  Ecobank, which operates in 34 African countries, said it would sign an agreement in China on 10 October 2026 to join China's CIPS interbank payment system for yuan transactions, chief executive Jeremy Awori told Reuters. It is also in talks with Bank of China to offer yuan settlement jointly. Rwanda's Bank of Kigali has joined CIPS and Angola's BFA plans to.

BANKS AND COUNTRIES CONNECTED TO PAPSS

- **PAPSS targets 100% African coverage within five years** — Businessday NG, 4 September 2026

  The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System opened its second strategic plan, aiming to connect every African country within five years, chief executive Mike Ogbalu told a Lagos press conference. It now links 30 countries and over 200 financial institutions and expects about 38 countries by end-2026; South Africa is the one large market not yet connected.

- **Nigerian churches drive rising cross-border payments across Africa, PAPSS says** — Nairametrics, 5 September 2026 NIGERIA

  The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (PAPSS) operates in 30 African countries and aims for about 38 by the end of 2026, its chief executive Mike Ogbalu said on 5 September 2026. He said PAPSS is exploring support for stablecoins, that Nigeria–Rwanda volumes are nearing Nigeria–Ghana volumes, and that church tithes sent to Nigeria from across Africa are a notable share of payments.

- **ABC Bank goes live on intra-African pay system** — Business Today Kenya, 7 September 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's African Banking Corporation (ABC Bank) has gone live on the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, letting customers send and receive payments across 28 African countries. Customers can pay accounts at more than 190 participating banks, sending either in Kenyan shillings or in the recipient's currency.

- **PAPSS transactions grow over 1,000% as Africa deepens cross-border payments** — The Sun (Nigeria), 7 September 2026

  The continental payment system's chief executive put transaction volume growth above 1,000% and value growth at 125% since 2022, with settlement averaging seven seconds against an original 120-second design target and an artificial-intelligence layer screening for suspicious activity before value is released. He declined to give the absolute volume and value, saying disclosure is still being agreed and a report will follow in early 2027.

- **Can PAPSS overcome regulatory hurdles to transform intra-African payments?** — TechCabal, 10 September 2026

  An account of what the pan-African payment system has built in four years and the regulatory obstacles still limiting it: 30 countries connected, about 200 financial institutions, and cross-border payments settling in an average of seven seconds against a 120-second design target. The system says it has cut the cost of cross-border transfers by up to 95 per cent and that volumes have grown more than tenfold over the past year.

- **PAPSS targets accelerated adoption and transaction growth as network expands across Africa** — African Export-Import Bank, 11 September 2026

  PAPSS chief executive Mike Ogbalu III said in Lagos on 11 September 2026 that transaction volumes on the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System rose about 1,000% and values about 120% between comparable periods of 2025 and 2026. The network covers more than 30 countries, 24 central banks, over 200 banks and payment providers and 16 switches; about 10 countries joined in 2026.

- **PAPSS goes live at I&M Bank Kenya to expand cross-border payments** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026 KENYA

  The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System went live for customers of I&M Bank Kenya, the second Kenyan bank on the network. Customers can send to participating African markets in Kenyan shillings through the bank's branches rather than converting into an international currency; no volume, fee or corridor detail was published.

PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (PAPSS)

- **PAPSS targets 100% African coverage within five years** — Businessday NG, 4 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **Nigerian churches drive rising cross-border payments across Africa, PAPSS says** — Nairametrics, 5 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **'Africa's payment system is shaping global finance landscape positively'** — The Nation (Nigeria), 6 September 2026

  PAPSS chief executive Mike Ogbalu III told journalists in Lagos that the payment system is live in 30 countries with 24 central banks and settles in seven seconds on average. It stores encrypted transaction data but no personal or KYC records, attempted attacks more than doubled in six months, and links to China's and India's payment systems are targeted for early 2027.

- **PAPSS transactions grow over 1,000% as Africa deepens cross-border payments** — The Sun (Nigeria), 7 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **PAPSS: Notes from a briefing with CEO Mike Ogbalu III** — Nigeriaworks (Tolu Ogunlesi), 7 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Mike Ogbalu, chief executive of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System launched by Afreximbank in 2022, briefed journalists in Lagos on its move to a second strategic plan from 2027. He said Afreximbank's settlement guarantee has grown from $500 million to $3 billion, that 15 central bank governors sit on its governing council, and that PAPSS has launched a currency marketplace and a card scheme.

- **Nigeria, fintechs critical to Africa's payment integration** — The Sun Nigeria, 8 September 2026 NIGERIA

  The chief executive of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, Mike Ogbalu III, told journalists in Lagos that the system lets businesses settle cross-border trade in local currencies and is drawing informal trade into the formal economy. He described its fraud controls, currency exchange arrangements and aim of covering the whole continent, and placed Nigeria's fintech sector at the centre of that effort.

- **Afreximbank plans PAPSS-Instapay link to expand Egypt-Africa cross-border payments** — Ahram Online, 9 September 2026 EGYPT

  The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System plans to connect to Instapay, Egypt's central-bank-licensed instant payment app, its chief executive Mike Ogbalu said at a Cairo conference held 7-9 September 2026. He said six Egyptian banks are awaiting central bank approval to join PAPSS, which operates in 30 African countries.

- **Can PAPSS overcome regulatory hurdles to transform intra-African payments?** — TechCabal, 10 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **PAPSS Targets China, India Payment Markets by Early 2027** — Todays Echo, 10 September 2026

  The pan-African payment system plans to connect to China's largest payment system and to have India's live on its platform by the first quarter of 2027, its chief executive told a Lagos media session, with Brazil and others later in the year. He put transaction volumes up more than 1,000 per cent year on year and 30 countries connected against about 38 targeted by the end of 2026.

- **PAPSS payments grew 1,000% in a year, and Kenya is now on the network** — tech-ish, 17 September 2026 KENYA

  Payments across the pan-African settlement network are reported to have grown about tenfold over the year while the average payment fell to about a fifth of its level a year earlier — many small transfers in place of a few large ones. Kenya's national switch is the first of its kind piloted for termination on the network.

STABLECOIN SETTLEMENT RAILS SERVING AFRICAN CROSS-BORDER PAYMENTS

- **Nigerian churches drive rising cross-border payments across Africa, PAPSS says** — Nairametrics, 5 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

COST OF SENDING US$200 TO SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

- **How Remittance Startups Are Undercutting Western Union Across Africa** — TechTrends Africa, 6 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Sending US$200 to sub-Saharan Africa cost an average of 8.46% in the third quarter of 2025, against a global average of 6.36%, according to World Bank figures cited by TechTrends Africa. Apps such as LemFi and Sendwave now run the London to Lagos corridor at about 2-3%, against around 7.8% in 2023.

COMMERCIAL STABLECOIN PAYOUT RAIL ACROSS AFRICAN MARKETS

- **DCSPay Partners With Kotani Pay to Expand Stablecoin Payouts Across Africa** — Tech Africa News, 8 September 2026

A stablecoin payments platform partnered a local payout provider to widen stablecoin payout and settlement across African markets.

TERRAPAY-ALIPAY+ CROSS-BORDER QR ACCEPTANCE

- **TerraPay and Alipay+ Partner to Enable Cross-Border QR Payments for African Wallets** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  TerraPay and Alipay+ announced a partnership to enable cross-border QR payments for African digital wallets. In the initial phase 15 African wallets connected to TerraPay's Xend interoperability network would be able to pay at more than 150 million merchants, extending the network from account-to-account transfers into in-store payments.

REGULATORY OBSTACLES TO INSTANT PAYMENT INTEROPERABILITY

- **Can PAPSS overcome regulatory hurdles to transform intra-African payments?** — TechCabal, 10 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

ASSOCIATION OF AFRICAN CENTRAL BANKS (AACB)

- **CBE Governor discusses AI applications in central banks at AACB meetings** — Ahram Online, 17 September 2026 EGYPT

  A high-level conference on artificial intelligence in central banking ran on the sidelines of the Association of African Central Banks' 48th annual meetings in Nairobi, covering AI in monetary policy and financial stability, in supervision and financial integrity, and in governance and risk management, with national readiness and regional cooperation on frameworks for responsible use.

- **Annual Meetings - Nairobi 2026** — AACB, 18 September 2026 KENYA

  The Association of African Central Banks held its 48th annual meetings in Nairobi from 13 to 18 September, hosted by the Central Bank of Kenya alongside its sixtieth-anniversary events and an AI conference. The published programme names the technical committee, bureau and assembly sittings and the member banks attending each.

PAPSSCARD

- **Egypt's Meeza Cards Set for Wider African Use Through PAPSS Integration** — WAYA, 20 September 2026 EGYPT

  Afreximbank is connecting the continental card scheme to Egypt's Meeza national card network so cards issued on either side work across more African markets. The first phase joins the two infrastructures and establishes a settlement layer; payment would be in the currency of the country being visited, and no availability date was given.

MASTERCARD WALLET PAY (WALLET INTEROPERABILITY SERVICES)

- **Mastercard Launches Wallet Pay to Expand Digital Wallet Interoperability Globally** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Mastercard launched Wallet Pay, a set of services letting digital wallets accept contactless, QR and online payments across its network. MTN and AXIAN are among the launch partners, alongside Alipay+ and others.

VERTO CARD (MULTI-CURRENCY CORPORATE CARD ON VISA)

- **Verto and Visa Launch Multi-Currency Corporate Cards for African Businesses** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Payments platform Verto and Visa launched the Verto Card, a corporate card for African businesses that funds and settles in 11 currencies with no FX markup on eligible ones and indirect access to 160 more. It runs on Visa's commercial rails rather than prepaid rails, which Verto blames for declined cross-border payments.

AIRTEL MONEY

- **Airtel Mobile Commerce N.V. - Intention to Float (RNS 9490V)** — Airtel Mobile Commerce N.V. (Airtel Money), via the London Stock Exchange Regulatory News Service, 23 September 2026

  Airtel Money, Airtel Africa's mobile money business in 13 African markets, announced on 23 September 2026 its intention to list on the London Stock Exchange. Existing shareholders will sell shares, raising no new capital, and the IFC agreed to buy up to £67.2m. Airtel Money reported about 53 million monthly active users and revenue of US$1,346m for the year to March 2026.

- **Airtel Africa plc - Airtel Money announcement of offer price (RNS 1687X)** — Airtel Africa plc, via the London Stock Exchange Regulatory News Service (Reuters REG feed on TradingView), 1 October 2026

  Airtel Africa's regulatory announcement gives the terms of the Airtel Money offer: existing shareholders sell 270 million shares, with up to 27 million more under an over-allotment option, leaving about 16.5% of the company in public hands. Airtel Africa sells only through the over-allotment option.

- **Airtel Money Sets IPO Price at £1.96 Per Share, Valuing Company at £5.3 Billion** — Tech Africa News, 1 October 2026

  Airtel Money set the price of its London share offer at GBP1.96, valuing the company at about GBP5.3 billion. Trading is expected to begin on 14 October.

- **Airtel Money begins trading on London Stock Exchange after an oversubscribed IPO** — The Financial Express, 12 October 2026

  Airtel Money began conditional trading on the London Stock Exchange on 9 October after an oversubscribed offer in which existing shareholders sold 270 million shares, raising about US$703 million. The shares ended just below the offer price on the first day, and unconditional dealings were due on 14 October.

INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEMS IN OPERATION

- **Access or usage? The financial inclusion impact of Africa's instant payments systems** — AfricaNenda, 29 September 2026

  AfricaNenda's 2026 report on inclusive instant payment systems finds, on data from 54 economies, that a live instant payment system raises how often account holders use their accounts but not account ownership. The average transaction fell from US$58 in 2021 to US$25.

MASTERCARD COLLABORATIONS WITH THE MOJALOOP FOUNDATION AND AFRICANENDA

- **Mastercard Partners With Mojaloop and AfricaNenda to Strengthen Instant Payments in Africa** — TechAfrica News, 30 September 2026

  Mastercard announced it will explore pairing its A2A Protect fraud and dispute service with the Mojaloop Foundation's open-source instant-payment software, and will support AfricaNenda on instant-payment policy and governance. No country, sum or timetable was stated.

PAYMENT SYSTEMS DIRECTIVE FOR AFRICA (PSDA)

- **Africa needs $120m, AU law to fix cross-border payments – AU** — The Sun Nigeria, 5 October 2026

  The African Union Commission and the AfricaNenda Foundation presented a framework in Nairobi on 5 October 2026 to harmonise cross-border payment rules across Africa. It would need a binding AU legal instrument, a supervisory body anchored in the Association of African Central Banks and a US$120m implementation fund. The 10-year plan names five regional blocs as pathfinders and Nigeria–Ghana as a pilot corridor.

- **Africa Eyes One Digital Payment Market Without A Single Currency** — Digitnomics, 6 October 2026

  The African Union Commission, supported by the AfricaNenda Foundation, is developing a regulatory framework for a single African digital payments market without a common currency. It covers licence passporting, interoperability standards, anti-money-laundering rules, consumer protection and data governance under a proposed ten-year roadmap, with Nigeria and Ghana discussed as a first corridor. The consultation's date is not given.

- **African Fintechs Seek One Licence For Continent-Wide Expansion** — Digitnomics, 7 October 2026

  African payment companies are pressing for licence passporting, under which a firm licensed in one country could operate in others without starting again. It is part of the African Union Commission's work with AfricaNenda on cross-border payment rules.

- **AfricaNenda trains Journalists On Inclusive Instant Digital Payments** — News Agency of Nigeria, 7 October 2026

  AfricaNenda says its payments regulation initiative with the African Union Commission has moved to implementation after a feasibility study found a harmonised framework workable. The study names eight priority areas, licence passporting and interoperability standards among them, and a phased roadmap.

COMESA REGIONAL PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (REPSS)

- **Cross-border payments as a necessity for Africa's resilience and economic transformation** — Bank for International Settlements (central bankers' speeches); speech by the Bank of Mauritius, 13 October 2026

  MAURITIUS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The Governor of the Bank of Mauritius, Priscilla Muthoora Thakoor, told a Financial Stability Board workshop in Port Louis on 15 July 2026 that sub-Saharan Africa will miss the G20's 2027 targets for cross-border payments. She described REPSS, SADC-RTGS, TCIB and PAPSS as complementary regional systems and warned that stablecoins could undermine monetary sovereignty. The speech was posted on 13 October.

SADC REAL-TIME GROSS SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (SADC-RTGS)

- **Cross-border payments as a necessity for Africa's resilience and economic transformation** — Bank for International Settlements (central bankers' speeches); speech by the Bank of Mauritius, 13 October 2026

  MAURITIUS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

TRANSACTIONS CLEARED ON AN IMMEDIATE BASIS (TCIB)

- **Cross-border payments as a necessity for Africa's resilience and economic transformation** — Bank for International Settlements (central bankers' speeches); speech by the Bank of Mauritius, 13 October 2026

  MAURITIUS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

Sectoral management information systems

CONTINENTAL BEHAVIOURAL INTELLIGENCE AND INFODEMIC MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

- **Africa CDC Calls for Stronger Community Engagement and Behavioural Intelligence to Boost Health Security** — Ommy Dallah, 3 September 2026 KENYA

  Africa CDC held a continental workshop in Mombasa to harmonise a common framework for behavioural intelligence and infodemic management in public health. Delegates from Kenya, Ghana, Zimbabwe, Burundi and Mauritania attended, and Africa CDC's senior regional representative urged countries to use available technology for health surveillance and communication. No cost or timetable for the framework is given.

- **Africa CDC advances public health intelligence framework** — The Star (Kenya), 4 September 2026 KENYA

  Africa CDC and member states validated components of a continental behavioural intelligence and infodemic management framework at a five-day meeting in Mombasa, with participants from six countries alongside the ECOWAS regional surveillance centre and the WHO Africa Infodemic Response Alliance. The framework is to turn community feedback, social listening, service-delivery and programme data and rapid research into decision-ready intelligence; Africa CDC states it is not another database or reporting platform.

REGIONAL HEALTH DATA HUB

- **WHO launches Regional Health Data Hub to turn health data into informed action** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 7 September 2026

  The regional health data hub launched at Addis Ababa carries 53 datasets and 7,965 indicators, about 65% of them ingested against a target of 80% by the end of 2026, and its governance framework is still in development. It is intended to bring maternal, newborn, child and adolescent health together with noncommunicable disease data across all 47 member states of the region.

BEHAVIOURAL INTELLIGENCE FRAMEWORK AND DATA ARCHITECTURE

- **Africa CDC To Harmonise Behavioural Intelligence** — LEADERSHIP Newspapers, 17 September 2026

  The continental health agency, with member states and technical partners, has validated a framework, a strategy, a digital and data architecture and a roadmap for harmonising behavioural intelligence and infodemic management, at a five-day workshop in Mombasa. None of the four documents is published.

DIGIT-HCM HEALTH-CAMPAIGN DIGITISATION INITIATIVE

- **WHO Africa launches the Health Campaign Digitization initiative (DIGIT-HCM) to transform health campaign planning and delivery across the Region** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 25 September 2026 CHAD

  The WHO Regional Office for Africa launched DIGIT-HCM, a three-year initiative to digitise the planning, delivery and monitoring of health campaigns such as vaccination drives, built with the eGov Foundation and supported by the Gates Foundation. The first phase covers seven pilot countries; a pilot ran in a district of N'Djamena Province during Chad's June 2026 polio campaign. No funding figure is given.

Coordination and collaboration

Innovation ecosystem · China activities · India activities

Innovation ecosystem

ATU AFRICA INNOVATION CHALLENGE

- **ATU opens fifth Africa Innovation Challenge with US$60,000 prize pool** — TechReviewAfrica, 17 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  The African Telecommunications Union opened applications for the fifth Africa Innovation Challenge, with a total prize pool of US$60,000. Côte d'Ivoire's digital minister, Djibril Ouattara, launched it in Abidjan during Africa's final preparatory meeting for the 2026 ITU Plenipotentiary Conference. The call focuses on AI-based software.

China activities

AFRICAN MEMBERSHIP OF THE WORLD ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE COOPERATION ORGANISATION

- **Opening the AI gateway** — China.org.cn, 1 September 2026

  China signed agreements with Côte d'Ivoire, Guinea and Cameroon to extend its Mazu weather-warning system in Africa, and showed Mazu Djibouti 2.0, which sharpens forecasts from 9km to 3km resolution. Ten African states, among them Algeria, Ethiopia, Kenya and South Africa, are founders of a new World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organisation based in Shanghai.

CHINESE INTELLIGENT WEATHER-WARNING SYSTEM IN AFRICA

- **Opening the AI gateway** — China.org.cn, 1 September 2026

  Summarised under China activities.

India activities

INDIA-AFRICA DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE COOPERATION

- **African delegations study India's digital identity systems under UNDP mission** — Biometric Update, 9 September 2026

  Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia completed a two-week mission to India under the UNDP's Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure programme, visiting Delhi, Pune and Bengaluru. They met India's identity authority, UIDAI, and its national payments corporation, NPCI, and studied digital ID, payments and data systems used in agriculture, health and social protection.

Capacity and inclusion

Training and skills · Digital divides

Training and skills

PAN-AFRICAN MEDIA INNOVATION PROGRAMME

- **MTN, UJ, TAEF Launch Pan-African Media Innovation Programme for 42 Journalists** — Tech Africa News, 1 September 2026

  MTN Group, the University of Johannesburg and The African Editors' Forum welcomed the first cohort of the MTN Pan-African Media Innovation Programme on 1 September 2026. The six-week course takes 42 journalists, editors and media practitioners from 10 countries, including South Africa, Nigeria, Rwanda, Ghana and South Sudan; the university chose the participants.

LEADERSHIP EXCELLENCE IN AFRICA'S PUBLIC SECTOR (LEAPS) PROGRAMME

- **Africa urged to put leadership at centre of public sector reforms** — The Star (Kenya), 3 September 2026

  KENYA GHANA SENEGAL ZIMBABWE GAMBIA CÔTE D'IVOIRE ETHIOPIA NIGERIA TANZANIA

The African Capacity Building Foundation argued that sound policies and public financial management reforms are failing at implementation because of leadership gaps, institutional fragmentation and resistance to change.

REGIONAL TRAINING IN DIGITAL LAND RECORD SYSTEMS

- **RCMRD Trains 55 African Officials on Digital Land Record Systems in Nairobi** — Space in Africa, 17 September 2026

  A regional mapping centre is training 55 officials from its 20 member states on planning and managing digital land record systems, over five days in Nairobi. The course covers bringing surveying, registration, valuation and mapping into one system, connecting it to national platforms so information is not re-entered, data accuracy and access control, and where state data should be hosted.

AI TRAINING FOR AFRICAN PUBLIC OFFICIALS (AFDB, UNDP AI HUB, GOOGLE, APOLITICAL)

- **UNGA81: African Development Bank Group and partners launch free AI training for African public officials** — African Development Bank Group, 24 September 2026

  The African Development Bank Group, the UNDP-led AI Hub for Sustainable Development, Google and Apolitical launched free, self-paced AI courses for African public officials at the UN General Assembly in New York, announced on 24 September 2026. The courses, by Stanford University Online and SDA Bocconi, cover AI fundamentals, leadership and procurement, and are open to officials in the Bank's regional member countries.

HER CYBERTRACKS WOMEN'S CYBERSECURITY PROGRAMME

- **Nearly 50 African women cybersecurity professionals gather in Addis Ababa for regional training** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

  Nearly 50 women cybersecurity professionals from across Africa met in Addis Ababa for the Her CyberTracks Regional Training Africa 2026. The programme is funded by Germany, the European Commission and Italy and delivered by the ITU and GIZ with UNODC's Global Programme on Cybercrime.

IPRIS REGULATORY CAPACITY PROGRAMME

- **African telecom regulators convene in Nairobi to strengthen cooperation on emerging digital challenges** — iPRIS, 5 October 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  A European-funded regulatory capacity programme is holding its eighth cohort in Nairobi from 5 to 9 October. Regulators from Liberia, Mauritius, Namibia, Sierra Leone, Tanzania and Zimbabwe are taking part with three regional regulators' associations.

Digital divides

GENDER GAP IN INTERNET USE

- **Internet users in Africa and globally** — The Star (Kenya), 15 September 2026

  Figures from the UN Economic Commission for Africa's Economic Report on Africa 2026 show 43% of African men and 31% of African women used the internet in 2024, a 12-point gap. Worldwide the rates were 70% and 65%. Women's use in Africa peaked at 34% in 2022.

SMARTPHONE SHIPMENTS AND ENTRY-LEVEL AFFORDABILITY

- **GSMA warns of emerging global AI divide as three billion people remain offline and smartphone component costs soar** — GSMA, 15 September 2026 GLOBAL

The GSMA released its State of Mobile Internet Connectivity Report 2026 in New York on 15 September 2026, saying more than 3.4 billion people still do not use mobile internet. By end-2025 an entry-level smartphone cost the poorest fifth in Sub-Saharan Africa 76% of average monthly income, and memory prices more than doubled between late 2025 and early 2026, driven by demand for AI data centres.

- **The State of Mobile Internet Connectivity 2026** — GSMA, 15 September 2026 SENEGAL GLOBAL

  The GSMA's State of Mobile Internet Connectivity 2026 finds 4.8 billion people, 59% of the world, use mobile internet on their own device. Sub-Saharan Africa has the lowest rate at 25%, with a 66% usage gap and a 9% coverage gap. Its survey puts mobile internet use in Senegal at 87% of urban and 75% of rural adults.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements · New investments

MoUs and other agreements

AUC-ITU COOPERATION MEMORANDUM

- **African Union Commission and ITU Sign MoU to Accelerate Africa's Digital Future** — African Union, 7 September 2026

  The African Union Commission and the International Telecommunication Union signed a memorandum of understanding in Geneva on 7 September 2026 setting a framework for cooperation on Africa's digital transformation. Priority areas include artificial intelligence, digital public infrastructure, skills, connectivity, cybersecurity, space technologies, regulation and standardisation. No funding commitment is stated.

K-AI PACKAGE

- **S. Korea vows closer cooperation with African partners at KOAFEC meeting** — Yonhap News Agency, 9 September 2026 TANZANIA

  South Korea set out the K-AI Package at the 8th KOAFEC ministerial in Seoul, tying AI solutions, AI data centres and power supply facilities to infrastructure projects financed by its Economic Development Cooperation Fund. Delegations from 45 African countries adopted a joint declaration, approved 13 new trust-fund projects and signed a letter of intent for a Korea-Africa AI Hub at the African Development Bank. No commitment sum is stated.

- **The government has decided to cooperate with 45 African countries in the artificial intelligence (AI) sector** — Maeil Business Newspaper (MK), English edition, 9 September 2026

  South Korea agreed to cooperate with 45 African countries on artificial intelligence, tying AI solutions, AI data centres and power supply facilities to projects financed by its Economic Development Cooperation Fund. No commitment sum is stated.

KOREA EXIMBANK-AFDB COOPERATION ON AI AND DIGITAL FINANCING

- **Korea Eximbank expands Africa financing in AI, critical minerals** — The Korea Herald, 10 September 2026

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

ECA-DHL MEMORANDUM ON SME CROSS-BORDER TRADE

- **ECA and DHL partner to advance MSMEs participation in intra-African trade** — UN Economic Commission for Africa, 14 September 2026

The UN Economic Commission for Africa and DHL Express Sub-Saharan Africa signed a non-exclusive three-year memorandum of understanding in Addis Ababa on 14 September 2026 to help small businesses trade across African borders under the AfCFTA. The first activity is a virtual training series on customs, logistics, e-commerce and digital trade through DHL's GoTrade programme. No financial value is attached.

- **UNECA, DHL Express Partner to Boost African SMEs in Cross-Border Trade Under AfCFTA** — The Reporter, 14 September 2026

  The UN Economic Commission for Africa and DHL Express Sub-Saharan Africa signed a three-year memorandum to help small businesses trade across African borders under the AfCFTA, through DHL's GoTrade programme. The first activity is a virtual training series on customs, logistics, e-commerce and digital trade tools. No value or signing date is given.

SMART AFRICA-KITSOFT MEMORANDUM ON PUBLIC-SECTOR DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

- **Kitsoft and Smart Africa to cooperate on digital transformation of governments** — Smart Africa, 15 September 2026

  The Smart Africa Secretariat signed a memorandum of understanding with Kitsoft, a GovTech company of Ukrainian origin, on public-sector digital transformation, announced on 15 September 2026. It covers digital public infrastructure, e-governance and AI, including building public services on Kitsoft's low-code Liquio platform. The release gives no signing date, value or duration.

- **Kitsoft and Smart Africa Sign MoU on Public Sector Digital Transformation** — Tech Africa News, 16 September 2026

  Smart Africa's secretariat signed a memorandum with Kitsoft, a GovTech firm of Ukrainian origin, on digital public infrastructure, e-government and AI, including building public services on low-code tools. No budget or country deployment is named.

KOREA-AFRICA AI HUB

- **Korea, African Development Bank sign deal to launch joint AI Hub to support Africa** — African Development Bank Group, 17 September 2026

  The African Development Bank and the Republic of Korea signed a letter of intent in Seoul to establish a joint hub for artificial intelligence, to support responsible development, adoption and financing of AI across the continent. It was signed on the sidelines of the eighth Korea-Africa ministerial conference; no capitalisation, host or start date is published.

- **South Korea, Africa pledge deeper AI partnership to accelerate continent's digital transformation** — African Development Bank Group, 17 September 2026

  At a press conference alongside the African Development Bank's president in Seoul, South Korea's deputy prime minister said Korea would deepen its partnership with Africa by expanding cooperation in artificial intelligence and digital technologies. The bank put AI's potential at up to US$1 trillion of African GDP by 2035.

ATU PARTNERSHIP WITH THE UN OFFICE FOR DIGITAL AND EMERGING TECHNOLOGIES

- **UNGA81: ATU calls for stronger protection of Africa's critical digital infrastructure** — Tech Review Africa, 22 September 2026

> The African Telecommunications Union's secretary general, John Omo, called for stronger protection of critical civilian digital infrastructure at a UN Office for Digital and Emerging Technologies roundtable during the 81st UN General Assembly in New York. He cited domestic data centres, cross-border fibre and internet exchange points, and a July 2026 partnership with the UN office on digital public infrastructure and AI.

New investments

> AFRICAN TECHNOLOGY EQUITY AND DEBT FUNDING

- **ChipMango raises $1.9 million to build Africa's chip-design talent** — TechCabal, 1 September 2026

  ChipMango, a California-headquartered chip design and engineering training company, closed a US$1.9 million seed round led by Atlantica Ventures to expand its engineering work and workforce platform across Africa.

> INVESTMENT IN A CARRIER-NEUTRAL DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE PLATFORM

- **Africa Finance Corporation and Vision Invest — WIOCC Group equity investment, 2026** — Africa Finance Corporation, 1 September 2026

  The Africa Finance Corporation's own announcement of the combined US$300 million equity subscription with Vision International Investment Company, stating the proceeds as data-centre deployment and consolidation, expansion of open-access terrestrial fibre and investment in new subsea assets. See the WIOCC entries for the transaction.

- **WIOCC Group Secures $300 Million Investment From AFC, Vision Invest to Expand Africa's Digital Infrastructure** — Tech Africa News, 1 September 2026

  A third account of the same WIOCC subscription agreement, adding no new terms. See above.

- **WIOCC Group Secures Strategic Investment from AFC and Vision Invest to Accelerate its Digital Infrastructure Expansion Across Africa** — Africa Finance Corporation, 1 September 2026

  WIOCC's own announcement of the US$300 million subscription agreement sets out that the money is to accelerate its digital infrastructure expansion across Africa. See the entry above for the transaction.

> AFDB-AXIAN DIGITAL FINANCE PROGRAMME FOR WOMEN-LED BUSINESSES

- **African Development Bank and AXIAN Launch Digital Finance Programme to Support 34,000 Women-led Businesses in Africa** — African Development Bank Group (distributed by APO Group), 2 September 2026 MADAGASCAR TANZANIA SENEGAL TOGO COMOROS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The African Development Bank and AXIAN Group launched a programme on 2 September 2026 to offer digital loans and financial services through AXIAN's Mixx and MVola mobile money platforms to 34,000 women-led small businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal. A second component will train 25,000 women in those countries plus Togo and the Comoros. No committed amount is stated.

> BOOST AFRICA

- **EU, EIB Invest EUR108m to Drive African Entrepreneurship, Create 15,000 Jobs** — THISDAYLIVE, 9 September 2026 NIGERIA

  The European Union and the European Investment Bank have invested €108 million through the Boost Africa initiative for African entrepreneurs, attracting a further €400 million and creating up to 15,000 jobs, the EU ambassador to Nigeria, Gautier Mignot, said in Abuja on 9 September 2026. He spoke ahead of the Boost Africa Impact Forum.

- **EU, EIB Highlight Boost Africa's Impact On Entrepreneurs** — Voice of Nigeria, 10 September 2026 NIGERIA

The EU and the European Investment Bank said at a forum in Abuja that their Boost Africa programme invested €108 million through venture capital funds over its first decade, attracting about €400 million more from other investors. EU ambassador Gautier Mignot named Nigeria a key beneficiary, and the EIB said it had launched new operations there.

UNITED STATES DEVELOPMENT FINANCE EQUITY IN A PAN-AFRICAN DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE OPERATOR

- **DFC Board of Directors Meeting, 16 September 2026 — Public Information Summary: WIOCC Holding Company Limited** — U.S. International Development Finance Corporation (DFC), 9 September 2026

  The US International Development Finance Corporation put to its board meeting of 16 September 2026 an equity investment of up to US$155m in WIOCC Holding Company, the African digital infrastructure group. Its public summary puts total project costs at up to US$450m, including about 25MW of new data-centre capacity.

- **DFC Announces More Than $8 Billion in Investments to Fuel American Economic and National Security Interests** — U.S. International Development Finance Corporation, 16 September 2026

  The US International Development Finance Corporation's board approved more than $8 billion of new investments on 16 September 2026, including an equity investment in WIOCC Group, a wholesale connectivity and data-centre provider in Africa. DFC described WIOCC as the preferred partner for US technology companies expanding in Africa. No amount was published for the WIOCC investment.

- **US backs African digital infrastructure** — ITWeb Africa, 22 September 2026

  The US International Development Finance Corporation said it intends to invest US$155 million in WIOCC Group, joining Africa Finance Corporation and Vision Invest as investors. The announcement followed an AFC roundtable in New York during the UN General Assembly; WIOCC operates in more than 30 African countries.

- **DFC Highlights U.S. Leadership in Economic Statecraft on Sidelines of U.N. General Assembly** — U.S. International Development Finance Corporation (DFC), 25 September 2026

  The US International Development Finance Corporation held a signing ceremony in New York during the UN General Assembly for its board-approved equity investment in WIOCC, the African digital infrastructure group. Executives from WIOCC, Vision and the Africa Finance Corporation attended. The release gives no amount.

- **The Money Was Already In The Room** — CIO Africa, 28 September 2026

  An analysis of WIOCC's funding notes that the US development finance agency joined a US$300m round three weeks after it was signed by a continental financier and a Saudi investor, with its own amount undisclosed and subject to congressional notification. It sets the round against data-centre costs of US$5-12m per megawatt, enough for tens rather than hundreds of megawatts.

UNITED KINGDOM DIGITAL DEVELOPMENT STRATEGY 2024-2030

- **FCDO Promises to Halve the Digital Divide. Where Is the Money?** — ICTworks, 10 September 2026

  NIGERIA KENYA GHANA RWANDA

  An ICTworks commentary argues that the UK Foreign Office's Digital Development Strategy 2024–2030 remains official policy but has little identifiable funding. The only digital line in published allocations is £70 million over three years for the Global Tech directorate, while the AI for Development programme alone is a £53 million commitment. The July 2026 development policy paper does not list digital as a priority.

FSD AFRICA-FUNDED STARTUP ACQUISITION PROGRAMME

- **Pula and S2E want to solve Africa's startup problem with British aid money** — TechCabal, 16 September 2026 KENYA

  FSD Africa, a UK aid-funded agency, is paying the consultancy S2E Africa to find corporate buyers for African startups and help them through deals, with insurtech Pula among the first clients. FSD Africa takes no stake in the acquisitions.

SLOANE CAPITAL STARTUP AND MSME FUND AND THE KUMII MATCHING PLATFORM

- **The push to connect Africa's startups is getting $63 million and an AI platform** — TechCabal, 16 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Cape Town's 22 On Sloane launched KUMii, an AI platform matching startups and small firms to funders, tenders and mentors, with more than 4,000 already registered. Its lending arm, Sloane Capital, is raising R1 billion, about US$63 million, to finance them.

BOOST VENTURES IN AFRICA

- **Africa's leading venture capital fund managers convene at Oxford to strengthen investment expertise and advance venture investing across Africa** — European Investment Bank, 28 September 2026

  The European Investment Bank and the European Commission launched Boost Ventures in Africa, backed by a €129 million Commission guarantee covering all fund investments and €4.5 million of initial EFSD+ technical assistance. It was announced at the fifth Africa Venture Finance Programme in Oxford, attended by more than 40 African and Africa-focused venture fund managers.

AI 10 BILLION INITIATIVE

- **African Development Bank and UNDP Advance AI 10 Billion Initiative to Turn Africa's AI Potential into Productivity** — African Development Bank, 14 October 2026

  The African Development Bank and UNDP said the AI 10 Billion Initiative has moved to delivery after a UNDP mission to the Bank in Abidjan. It is to start in five countries and reach 20 by the end of 2027, arranging US$1 billion a year for ten years; no country, contributor or committed sum is named.

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